

FEMA Damage Assessment Quick Guide

Sept 2023

	No Vis. Damage	Affected	Minor	Major	Destroyed
Flood	No visible damage No standing water No blue tarps	Water damage or touches structure Piles of debris Surrounded by water	*if level can be determined* Water line >1' to 1st floor windows	*if level can be determined* Water line between 1st floor windows and roof	Evidence of water to roof or 1st ceiling 2+ structural failures Only foundation remains
Hurricane or Tornado		Superficial/cosmetic damage Shingles, siding, gutters missing No holes in roof Quick repairs	Temp inhabitable, repairable Non-structural damage 1/4-1/2 roof missing, framing not damaged Some ext wall damage, not collapsed	Unsafe Extensive repairs Failure or partial failure of roof, walls, foundation ≤ 3/4 roof covering missing 1/4-1/2 roof damaged Interior exposed Extensive ext damage Structure moved	2+ structural failures Cannot be repaired Loss of structure Complete collapse
Fire					Burned to ground Roof/interior walls missing
Volcano					Covered or touching lava

Guidelines

- **Follow mission instructions, mission assessment parameters may override these defaults**
- Uncertain? Assign lower damage category
- Must verify every structure with pre and post-disaster images
- Only assess what you can see, assess each structure independently
- Fallen tree or tarp obstructs view = Affected
- Use No Visible Damage when no damage visible in imagery from current incident
- Add assessments over structures missing polygons
- Add multiple assessments when polygon covers multiple structures

Tips

- Take your time
- Actively use base maps and slider
- Use Google maps, street view, satellite, labels



FEMA

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Civil Air Patrol